

INSTRUCTIONS PUT A STAR NEXT TO YOUR TOP 3

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0. Our original idea (Popularity heat map) ★★

- **Problem:** People scroll social media saving travel ideas and seeing popular recommendations without actually visiting or executing on the idea
- **Why they care:** people love quality time and great spots yet often don't know where to find one
- **Pain Score:** 7

1. The "Instagram vs. Reality" Gap

- **Problem:** Travelers arrive at viral spots and find them overcrowded, under construction, or nothing like the video.
- **Why they care:** They've spent limited vacation time and money chasing a place that was staged or outdated.
- **Solution:** Heat map filters by recency (last 48 hours vs. last 6 months) and surfaces unfiltered "reality check" clips next to the polished viral ones.
- **Pain score:** 8

2. The Crowd-Avoider (Inverse Heat Map) ★★

- **Problem:** Some travelers want the opposite of trending. They want beautiful places without the crowds.
- **Why they care:** Crowds make them anxious and ruin the experience they came for.
- **Solution:** Flip the map to show "cooling" spots: places with strong past engagement but low current activity, plus best-time-to-visit predictions.
- **Pain score:** 7

3. The Solo Female Traveler ★★

- **Problem:** She doesn't know which neighborhoods feel safe at different times of day, and that information lives in scattered TikToks and Reddit threads.
- **Why they care:** Safety is the top source of travel anxiety for this group and directly shapes where she goes.

- **Solution:** A map layer that aggregates safety-related social content by area and time, tagged by solo women travelers specifically.
- **Pain score:** 9

4. The Group Trip Decision Deadlock

- **Problem:** Friend groups send each other dozens of TikToks in a group chat, then can't agree on or remember any of them.
- **Why they care:** Planning becomes a chore and the loudest person usually decides.
- **Solution:** Shared group map where everyone drops saved videos, votes on pins, and the app auto-builds a day route from the top picks.
- **Pain score:** 8

5. The Layover and Business Traveler★

- **Problem:** They have 4 to 6 free hours in a city and no time to research.
- **Why they care:** Wasting a rare free window feels bad, but planning it feels like work.
- **Solution:** "I have X hours from here" mode that generates a walkable, time-boxed route from nearby trending spots.
- **Pain score:** 6

6. The Local Who's Bored of Their Own City

- **Problem:** Residents don't know what's new or trending in their own city beyond their usual spots.
- **Why they care:** They want weekend plans and date ideas without scrolling for an hour.
- **Solution:** A local mode with weekly "what's heating up near you" alerts and new-opening detection from social chatter.
- **Pain score:** 6 (real, but many competitors fight for this user)

7. The Small Business That Went Viral (B2B)

- **Problem:** A café or small attraction gets a viral video but can't tell where traffic comes from or how to sustain it.
- **Why they care:** Viral moments are unpredictable revenue spikes they can't plan staffing or inventory around.
- **Solution:** Dashboard showing businesses their social heat over time, with alerts when they start trending and options to promote on the map.
- **Pain score:** 7 (also your likeliest monetization path)

8. The Accessibility-Needs Traveler★

- **Problem:** Travelers with mobility needs can't tell from a polished video whether a spot has stairs, ramps, or seating.
- **Why they care:** Showing up to an inaccessible place means a wasted trip and real physical cost.

- **Solution:** Crowdsourced accessibility tags layered onto trending pins, with video clips showing entrances and paths.
- **Pain score:** 8 (high pain, smaller market, strong mission story)

9. The Content Creator Hunting Fresh Spots

- **Problem:** Creators need locations before they're saturated, since reposting a spot everyone has filmed gets no traction.
- **Why they care:** Their income depends on being early.
- **Solution:** "Emerging" filter that detects spots with rapidly accelerating mentions but low total volume, plus golden-hour and crowd timing.
- **Pain score:** 7

10. The Anxious First-Time International Traveler

- **Problem:** They freeze up in unfamiliar places because they don't know what "normal" looks like: how to order, tip, get around, or behave.
- **Why they care:** Not knowing the unwritten rules makes them avoid going out at all.
- **Solution:** Pins include short "how it actually works here" clips pulled from social (ordering at this market, paying for this train) so users see the experience before they arrive.
- **Pain score:** 8